UNIT 9

Political Ideologies – Part II



Learning Objectives

- To understand the etymology, characteristics, kinds and thinkers of Anarchism
- To comprehend the meaning, emergence and diverse schools of Feminism
- To know a few measures of the Indian State to promote women empowerment
- To have knowledge about the emergence, thinkers and main characteristics of communitarianism especially its stand on Man, Society, Rights and Justice
- To grasp the meaning and thinkers of Post Modernism and also to examine its views on multiplicity of truth, particularism and identity politics
- To know the basic concepts like Deep Ecology, Shallow Ecology and Ecological Political Theory
- To identify a few important Ecological Movements of India

9.1 Anarchism

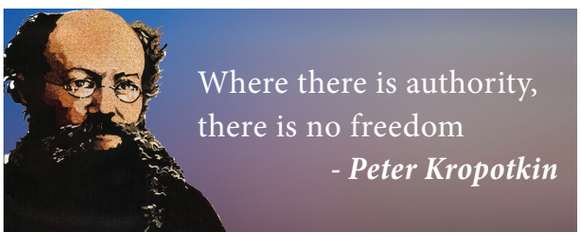
Anarchism is a political ideology that advocates the model of self-governed societies based on innate cooperative instincts of man. Etymologically, anarchism is derived from the Greek word 'anarchos' meaning 'without authority'. One of the earliest political philosophers of anarchism was Pierre Joseph Proudhon who famously described profit as theft.

Russian thinker Peter Kropotkin and Russian author Leo Tolstoy are among the other important advocates of this philosophy.

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Anarchism as an ideology seeks to abolish all authority and emancipate man from the State, property and religion. It alternatively visualizes a society based on voluntary association of human beings.

Anarchism considers the State as an unnecessary evil. State is an evil because it suppresses rights and liberties of man hindering his moral development. Unlike the negative liberalists who called the State necessary even though it is an evil, anarchism rejects the State as an unnecessary institution. They argue that the state does not perform any useful function in society and, therefore, it must be exterminated immediately. Bakunin, another famous anarchist thinker asserted that if there is a State, there must be domination and subjugation of one class by another class and therefore all States must vanish.



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